

Episode 3: This time around it was the Sega Genesis and the SNES who were battling it out. The SNES came out much later, and enjoyed good sales as well. In fact, the Genesis was in trouble at first. No one was buying the console, and that trend continued until the release of *Sonic the Hedgehog*. It was only then that it really started to become big. Although the SNES had no such trouble, it still couldn't beat the Genesis in terms of sales, and therefore lost the battle.

Once again, rather ironically, Sega won the battle, but lost the war. Their attempts to usher in CD-based consoles proved to be too hasty, and soon they were on their way out of the industry. In many ways, this was the beginning of the end for Sega the console giant.

Episode 4: By this time, the Sony PlayStation was out. It did face competition from the N64 and Sega's Saturn, but there was never really a doubt about who would come out on top. The Saturn failed because of poor marketing and lack of games. While the PlayStation is credited with tapping into a new market by selling itself as a lifestyle accessory to people in their late teens and early 20s, the Saturn was aimed at children. The end result—PlayStation becomes wildly successful, Saturn doesn't.

The N64 suffered primarily because it was the last cartridge-based gaming console. In spite of the advantages of a cartridge, the high cost of manufacturing such cartridges, and the space limits it enforced upon developers meant it never really took off. Further, the high cost of the console itself drove many potential customers away.

Bottomline—Sony won this one hands down. Nobody even came close!

Episode 5: We now come to the current generation of consoles. This time around it was Sony with their PlayStation 2, going against industry old-timers Nintendo. But a new player had entered the scene. Microsoft and its Xbox shook up the market. Although suffering initially, the Xbox did well after the first year. It never managed to dethrone the PlayStation 2, however. Sony made full